

DAYANANDA SAGAR UNIVERSITY

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**SCHOOL OF
ENGINEERING**

Bachelor of Technology

in

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

(ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND MACHINE LEARNING)

A Project Report On

AI HANDWRITTEN EVALUATION SYSTEM

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(ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND MACHINE LEARNING)

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project entitled “ **AI-BASED HANDWRITTEN EVALUATION SYSTEM**” is carried out by **MARY NISHA RICHEL.V(ENG23AM0253), SAMRUDDHI.K(ENG23AM0271), M.RAMA CHARITHA(ENG23AM0156)**

bonafide students of Bache-lor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering at the School of Engineering, Dayananda Sagar University, Bangalore, in partial fulfillment for the award of a degree in Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering, during the year **2025 - 2026**.

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DECLARATION

We, **Mary Nisha Richel.V (ENG23AM0253), M.Rama Charitha (ENG23AM0156), Samruddhi.K(ENG23AM0271)** are students of the seventh semester B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML) at the School of Engineering, Dayananda Sagar University. We hereby declare that the Major Project titled “Privacy-Preserving Synthetic Tabular Data using Conditional GAN (CTGAN)” has been carried out by us and submitted in partial fulfillment for the award of a degree in Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering during the academic year 2025–2026.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

It is a great pleasure for us to acknowledge the assistance and support of many individuals who have been responsible for the successful completion of this project work. First, we take this opportunity to express our sincere gratitude to School of Engineering & Technology, Dayananda Sagar University for providing us with a great opportunity to pursue our Bachelor's degree in this institution.

We would like to thank **Dr. Udaya Kumar Reddy K R, Dean, School of Engineering & Technology, Dayananda Sagar University** for his constant encouragement and expert advice. It is a matter of immense pleasure to express our sincere thanks to **Dr. Jayavrinda Vrindavanam, Department Chairman, Computer Science and Engineering (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning), Dayananda Sagar University**, for providing right academic guidance that made our task possible.

We would like to thank our guide **Prof. Pradeep Kumar K, Assistant Professor, Dept. of Computer Science and Engineering of Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Dayananda Sagar University** for sparing his valuable time to extend help in every step of our project work, which paved the way for smooth progress and the fruitful culmination of the project.

We would like to thank our **Project Coordinator Dr. Vinutha N & Prof. Pradeep Kumar K** as well as all the staff members of Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML) for their support. We are also grateful to our family and friends who provided us with every requirement throughout the course. We would like to thank one and all who directly or indirectly helped us in the Project work

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ABSTRACT

The AI Handwritten Evaluation System is an advanced technological solution aimed at automating process of evaluating handwritten answer scripts with improved accuracy, efficiency, and consistency. Traditional manual evaluation methods are often time-consuming, prone to human error, and may lack uniformity in grading. To address these challenges, the proposed system integrates Artificial Intelligence techniques such as image processing, Optical Character Recognition (OCR), and Natural Language Processing (NLP) to analyze and assess handwritten responses effectively.

The system first captures handwritten documents in digital form and preprocesses them to enhance image quality, remove noise, and segment text regions. OCR techniques are then applied to convert handwritten content into machine-readable text. Following this, NLP algorithms are used to interpret the extracted text, understand its semantic meaning, and compare it with predefined model answers or evaluation rubrics. The system assigns scores based on accuracy, relevance, and completeness of the response, ensuring objective and unbiased evaluation.

Additionally, the system is capable of handling diverse handwriting styles and provides meaningful feedback to students, highlighting areas of improvement. It significantly reduces the workload of educators, minimizes evaluation time, and enhances scalability for large volumes of answer scripts. This makes it highly suitable for academic institutions, online examinations, and large-scale competitive assessments. Overall, the AI Handwritten Evaluation System contributes to a more reliable, transparent, and efficient examination process by leveraging modern AI-driven methodologies.

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

The rapid advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AI) has significantly transformed various sectors, including education. One of the critical challenges in the education system is the evaluation of handwritten answer scripts, which is traditionally performed manually by educators. This process is not only time-consuming and labor-intensive but also subject to inconsistencies, human bias, and errors. With the increasing number of students and examinations, there is a growing need for an efficient, accurate, and scalable solution to streamline the evaluation process.

The AI Handwritten Evaluation System is designed to address these challenges by automating the assessment of handwritten responses using modern AI techniques. The system combines image processing, Optical Character Recognition (OCR), and Natural Language Processing (NLP) to convert handwritten text into digital format and evaluate it intelligently. By understanding the content and context of student answers, the system can compare them with predefined model answers or marking schemes and assign appropriate scores.

This system not only ensures faster evaluation but also maintains consistency and fairness in grading. It is capable of handling variations in handwriting styles and can process large volumes of answer scripts efficiently. Furthermore, it provides constructive feedback to students, helping them improve their performance. The implementation of such a system can greatly reduce the burden on educators and enhance the overall effectiveness of the examination process.

In conclusion, the AI Handwritten Evaluation System represents a significant step toward the modernization of educational assessment by leveraging AI-driven technologies to create a more reliable, transparent, and efficient evaluation framework.

1.1 Privacy-Preserving Data Impact in Modern Applications

The increasing use of Artificial Intelligence in educational systems has led to the collection and processing of large amounts of student data. However, this raises serious concerns regarding data privacy and security. In the AI Handwritten Evaluation System, student answer scripts and personal information must be handled securely to prevent unauthorized access and misuse.

- **Key Findings:** The system ensures that sensitive student data is protected through secure storage, encryption, and controlled access mechanisms while maintaining evaluation accuracy.
- **Research Publication:** The integration of privacy-preserving techniques such as data anonymization and secure processing helps in maintaining confidentiality without affecting system performance.
- **Implications and Need for Further Study:** There is a need to explore advanced privacy methods like differential privacy and secure multi-party computation to further strengthen data protection.
- **Geographical Context:** With the rapid adoption of digital education systems, especially in countries like India, ensuring student data privacy has become highly important.
- **Call for Action:** Educational institutions should adopt AI systems that incorporate strong privacy-preserving mechanisms to ensure secure and ethical use of student data.

1.2 Comparisons with Previous Studies:

- **Data Modeling Capability:** Earlier systems focused mainly on objective-type questions and lacked the ability to evaluate descriptive handwritten answers effectively. The proposed system uses OCR and NLP to interpret and evaluate handwritten content accurately.
- **Handling of Categorical Data:** Traditional systems struggled with different handwriting styles. The proposed system is designed to handle diverse handwriting patterns using advanced image processing techniques.
- **Imbalanced Data Handling:** Previous rule-based systems provided limited accuracy. The proposed AI-based system improves evaluation by understanding context, semantics, and relevance of answers.
- **Training Stability:** Earlier methods required significant human intervention. The proposed system automates the evaluation process, reducing time and effort while ensuring consistency.

Conclusion:

Compared to previous studies, the AI Handwritten Evaluation System offers improved accuracy, scalability, and reliability, making it more suitable for real-world educational applications

Chapter 2

PROBLEM DEFINITION AND OBJECTIVE

2.1 Problem Definition:

The traditional method of evaluating handwritten answer scripts is time-consuming, labor-intensive, and often prone to human errors and inconsistencies. With the increasing number of students and examinations, manual evaluation becomes inefficient and difficult to scale. Additionally, differences in handwriting styles, evaluator bias, and lack of uniform grading standards further affect the accuracy and fairness of the evaluation process.

There is a strong need for an automated system that can accurately interpret handwritten text and evaluate answers in a consistent, unbiased, and efficient manner. The challenge lies in converting handwritten digital format, understanding the meaning of responses, and assigning appropriate scores based on predefined criteria.

Approach: The proposed system uses Artificial Intelligence techniques such as image processing, Optical Character Recognition (OCR), and Natural Language Processing (NLP) to automatically evaluate handwritten answer scripts.

Key Functions: The system captures handwritten input, preprocesses the image, converts it into machine-readable text, and evaluates the content based on accuracy, relevance, and completeness.

In-Depth Analysis:

- **Text Recognition:** OCR techniques are used to accurately extract handwritten text from images.
- **Content Understanding:** NLP algorithms analyze the semantic meaning of answers.
- **Automated Scoring:** The system compares student responses with model answers to assign marks..

- **Data Quality and Accuracy:** The system ensures high accuracy by handling variations in handwriting styles and maintaining consistency in evaluation.
- **Significance:** The system reduces human effort, minimizes bias, and ensures faster and more reliable evaluation of answer scripts..
- **Comparison with Traditional Methods:** Manual evaluation is slow and inconsistent, whereas the proposed system provides automated, fast, and unbiased results

Potential Impact:

- 1.Time Efficiency:** Reduces evaluation time significantly compared to manual checking.
- 2.Consistency:** Ensures uniform grading standards across all answer scripts.
- 3.Scalability:** Can handle large volumes of answer sheets efficiently.
- 4.Improved Learning:** Provides feedback to students for better understanding and improvement

.Research and Validation:

- **Experimental Evaluation:** The system can be evaluated using accuracy metrics such as text recognition accuracy and grading consistency.
- **Data Utilization:** Comparison between manual and automated evaluation highlights improved efficiency and reliability.

SDG Goals :

- **Goal 4 : Quality Education:** Enhances learning and assessment through advanced AI-based evaluation systems.
- **Goal 9: Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure:** Promotes innovation in educational technology.
- **Goal 16: Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions:** Ensures fair and unbiased evaluation practices.

2.2 Novelty of Proposed Approach

- The proposed AI Handwritten Evaluation System introduces a modern and efficient solution to automate the evaluation process using advanced Artificial Intelligence techniques.
 - The system integrates image processing, Optical Character Recognition (OCR), and Natural Language Processing (NLP) to form a complete automated pipeline for evaluating handwritten answers.
 - It is capable of accurately recognizing and interpreting various handwriting styles, overcoming a major limitation of traditional systems.
 - Unlike basic keyword-based evaluation methods, the system focuses on understanding the semantic meaning and context of student responses, leading to more accurate grading.
 - It ensures unbiased and consistent evaluation by eliminating human subjectivity and errors.
 - The system supports large-scale implementation, making it suitable for universities, competitive exams, and online learning platforms.
 - It provides real-time feedback and performance insights to students, helping them improve their understanding and learning outcomes.
 - The approach can be enhanced further using deep learning models and adaptive learning techniques for continuous improvement.
 - Overall, the system offers a reliable, scalable, and intelligent solution for modernizing the evaluation process in education.

Chapter 3

LITERATURE

SURVEY

The literature on automated evaluation systems highlights the growing importance of Artificial Intelligence in transforming traditional educational practices. Early approaches to answer evaluation primarily focused on objective-type questions using rule-based systems and simple pattern matching techniques. While these methods were effective for multiple-choice questions, they lacked the ability to evaluate descriptive answers and could not handle handwritten content.

With the advancement of image processing and machine learning techniques, Optical Character Recognition (OCR) systems were introduced to convert handwritten or printed text into machine-readable format. Initial OCR systems were mainly designed for printed text and struggled with handwritten inputs due to variations in writing styles, noise, and image quality. This limitation restricted their application in real-world educational scenarios.

Recent developments in deep learning have significantly improved handwriting recognition capabilities. Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) have been widely used for recognizing handwritten text with higher accuracy. These models can learn complex patterns in handwriting and adapt to different writing styles, making them suitable for automated evaluation systems.

In addition to text recognition, Natural Language Processing (NLP) plays a crucial role in understanding and evaluating the content of student answers. Earlier systems relied on keyword matching techniques, which often failed to capture the actual meaning and context of responses. Modern NLP techniques, including semantic analysis and transformer-based models, enable systems to evaluate answers based on relevance, coherence, and completeness, leading to more accurate grading.

Several research studies have explored automated essay scoring systems, which evaluate typed responses using machine learning algorithms. While these systems demonstrate good performance, they are limited to digital text inputs and do not address the challenges of handwritten answer evaluation. This gap has led to the development of AI-based systems that combine OCR and NLP to create a complete evaluation pipeline for handwritten responses.

Despite significant progress, challenges still exist in this domain. Variations in handwriting styles, ambiguity in language, and differences in answer structure can affect evaluation accuracy. Additionally, ensuring fairness and avoiding bias in automated grading systems remains an important concern. Researchers are continuously working on improving model accuracy, interpretability, and robustness to overcome these limitations.

Evaluation of such systems is typically performed using metrics like accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score for text recognition, along with grading consistency and correlation with human evaluation for answer assessment. User feedback and real-world testing are also essential to validate system performance and usability.

In conclusion, the literature shows a clear evolution from basic rule-based systems to advanced AI-driven approaches for automated evaluation. The integration of OCR and NLP techniques has enabled the development of intelligent systems capable of evaluating handwritten answers with improved accuracy and efficiency. The proposed AI Handwritten Evaluation System builds upon these advancements to provide a scalable, reliable, and unbiased solution for modern educational assessment.

Recent studies have focused on integrating OCR and NLP into a unified framework to create intelligent systems capable of evaluating handwritten responses. This integration allows the system to first convert handwritten text into digital form and then analyze the content for grading. Such systems aim to replicate human evaluation by considering both the correctness and quality of answers.

Despite these advancements, several challenges remain in the field. Variability in handwriting styles, poor image quality, and incomplete or ambiguous answers can affect recognition and evaluation accuracy. Additionally, ensuring fairness and avoiding bias in automated grading systems is a critical concern. Researchers are exploring techniques such as explainable AI (XAI) to make evaluation decisions more transparent and trustworthy.

The performance of AI-based evaluation systems is typically measured using metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score for text recognition, along with correlation metrics to compare automated scores with human evaluation. These evaluation methods help in assessing both the technical performance and practical usability of the system.

Chapter 4

METHODOLOGY

4.1 Dataset Collection

- To develop an effective AI Handwritten Evaluation System, a suitable dataset consisting of handwritten answer scripts is required. The dataset is collected from various sources such as student answer sheets, publicly available handwriting datasets, and manually created samples
- **Data Sources:** Handwritten answer sheets collected from students, scanned documents, and standard datasets like IAM Handwriting Database or MNIST (for character-level training).
- **Data Preparation and Storage:** The collected data is stored in image formats (JPEG/PNG) and organized systematically for further processing
- **Preprocessing Stages:**
 - **Image Cleaning:** Removal of noise, blur, and unwanted marks from scanned documents.
 - **Segmentation:** Dividing the document into lines, words, or characters.
 - **Normalization:** Adjusting size, orientation, and contrast for better recognition.
 - **Data Annotation:** Labeling text data for training OCR models.

4.2 Dataset Selection for Model Building:

- **Selected Datasets:** A combination of handwritten text images and corresponding ground truth text is used for training and testing.
- **Training Data:** Contains labeled handwritten samples used to train OCR and NLP models.
- **Validation Data:** Used to tune model parameters and avoid overfitting.
- **Testing Data:** Used to evaluate system performance on unseen data.
- **Dataset Splitting:** Typically divided into training (70%), validation (15%), and testing (15%).
- **Dataset Diversity:** Includes different handwriting styles, languages (if applicable), and writing conditions to improve model robustness.
- **Impact on Model Performance:** A diverse dataset improves recognition accuracy and generalization ability of the system.

4.3 Model Training and Data Processing:

The system integrates OCR and NLP models to process and evaluate handwritten answers.

- **Training Conditions:** The OCR model is trained on preprocessed handwritten images, while NLP models are trained on textual data for semantic understanding.
- **Data Processing Parameters:**
 - **Image Input:** Handwritten text images.
 - **Text Output:** Extracted digital text using OCR.
 - **Evaluation Input:** Extracted text passed to NLP model for analysis.

Processing Steps:

1. Input handwritten image
2. Preprocess image
3. Apply OCR to extract text
4. Analyze text using NLP
5. Compare with model answers
6. Generate score and feedback

4.4 Efficiency and Advantages of the Methodology:

- **Accurate Text Recognition:** Advanced OCR techniques ensure high accuracy in extracting handwritten text
- **Semantic Understanding:** NLP enables understanding of meaning rather than simple keyword matching.
- **Automated Evaluation:** Reduces manual effort and speeds up the grading process.
- **Scalability:** Can handle large volumes of answer scripts efficiently.
- **Consistency:** Provides uniform grading without human bias.
- **Adaptability:** Can be extended to different subjects and question type

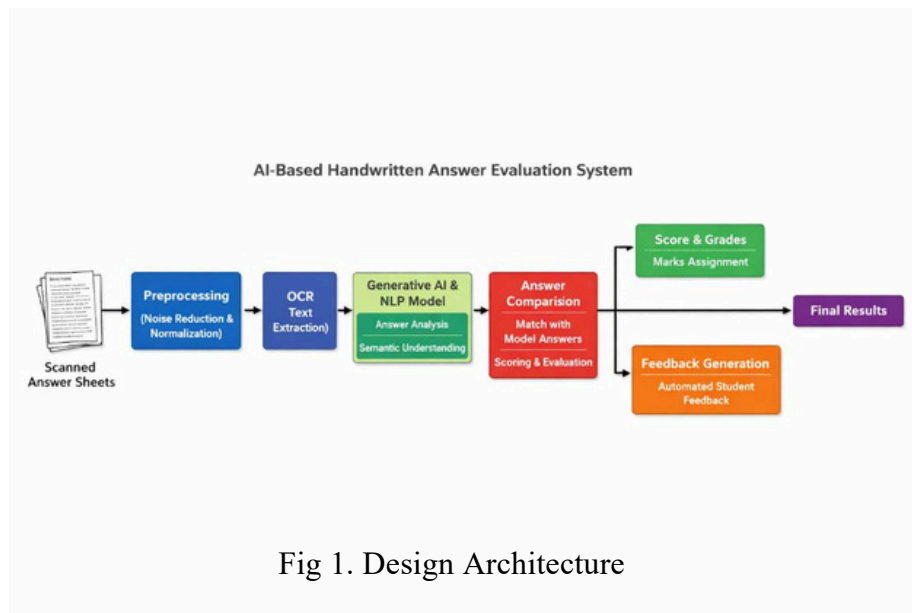


Fig 1. Design Architecture

4.5 Handling Handwritten Text Variability

Handling variations in handwritten text is one of the most challenging aspects of designing an AI-based handwritten evaluation system. Unlike printed text, handwriting differs significantly from person to person in terms of style, size, spacing, alignment, and stroke patterns. These variations can affect the accuracy of text recognition and, consequently, the evaluation process.

To address these challenges, the system employs advanced deep learning models trained on diverse handwriting datasets. By exposing the model to a wide range of handwriting styles during training, it learns to generalize better and accurately recognize different writing patterns. This improves the robustness and adaptability of the system in real-world scenarios.

Preprocessing techniques play a crucial role in reducing variability. Steps such as noise removal, skew correction, contrast enhancement, and normalization help standardize input images before they are processed by the OCR model. These techniques ensure that variations caused by scanning errors, lighting conditions, or paper quality are minimized.

Additionally, data augmentation techniques are used to further enhance model performance. Methods such as rotation, scaling, flipping, and distortion are applied to training images to simulate different handwriting conditions. This helps the model become more resilient to variations and improves its ability to handle unseen handwriting styles.

Brief on Data Representation:

Data representation plays a crucial role in the AI Handwritten Evaluation System as it determines how handwritten input is processed and understood by the model. The system converts handwritten images into structured digital data that can be analyzed efficiently.

Initially, handwritten answer scripts are captured as image data. These images are then preprocessed and passed through OCR, which converts them into machine-readable text. This text is further transformed into numerical representations using techniques such as tokenization, word embeddings, or vectorization, enabling the system to process and analyze the content.

For effective evaluation, the textual data is represented in a structured format where important features such as keywords, sentence structure, and semantic meaning are captured. NLP models use these representations to compare student answers with model answers and assess their relevance and correctness.

4.6 Evaluation and Feedback Generation

The evaluation and feedback generation module is the final stage of the AI Handwritten Evaluation System, where the extracted text is analyzed and scored. After OCR converts handwritten input into digital text, Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques are applied to understand the content, context, and meaning of the student's response

The system compares the extracted answer with predefined model answers or marking schemes using semantic similarity techniques rather than simple keyword matching. This allows the system to evaluate answers based on relevance, correctness, and completeness, even if the wording differs. Important features such as key concepts, sentence structure, and logical flow are considered during scoring.

A scoring mechanism is implemented to assign marks based on predefined criteria. The system ensures consistency and fairness in evaluation by applying the same standards to all responses, eliminating human bias. In addition, partial marking can be provided for answers that are partially correct, improving evaluation accuracy.

The feedback generation component provides detailed insights to students, highlighting correct points, missing concepts, and areas for improvement. This helps students understand their mistakes and enhances their learning experience.

The performance of the system is evaluated using metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and consistency with human grading. Overall, this module ensures efficient, reliable, and transparent evaluation of handwritten answers while supporting student learning through constructive feedback.

Chapter 5

REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Hardware Requirements:

The AI Handwritten Evaluation System requires standard computing hardware capable of handling image processing and machine learning tasks. The system can be developed and deployed on commonly available devices without the need for specialized infrastructure.

Minimum Hardware Requirements:

- **Processor:** Intel Core i3 / AMD equivalent or higher
- **RAM:** 4GB (8 GB recommended for better performance)
- **Storage:** 256 GB HDD / SSD
- **System Type:** 64-bit Operating System
- **Display:** 1366 × 768 resolution monitor
- **Input Devices:** Keyboard and Mouse

Recommended Hardware Requirements (for efficient performance):

- **Processor:** Intel Core i5 / i7 or AMD Ryzen 5/7
- **RAM:** 8GB or higher
- **Storage:** 512GB SSD (for faster processing and data access)
- **GPU (Optional):** NVIDIA GPU with CUDA support (useful for deep learning models)
- **Scanner/Camera:** For capturing handwritten documents

Additional Requirements:

- Stable power supply
- Internet connection (for model training, updates, or cloud-based deployment)

5.2 Software Requirements:

- **Python:**

Version 3.7 or later for implementing handwriting recognition models, image preprocessing, and evaluation tasks.

- **Integrated Development Environment (IDE):**

Tools such as Jupyter Notebook, PyCharm, or Visual Studio Code for efficient coding, experimentation, and debugging.

- **Libraries and Frameworks:**

- PyTorch / TensorFlow: Deep learning frameworks for building and training handwriting recognition models.
- OpenCV: Used for image processing tasks such as noise removal, segmentation, and feature extraction.
- Tesseract OCR: Used for extracting text from handwritten documents.
- Scikit-learn: Used for preprocessing, evaluation, and implementing machine learning models.
- NumPy and Pandas: Essential libraries for data manipulation, analysis, and numerical operations.
- Matplotlib and Seaborn: Visualization libraries for plotting graphs, distributions, and performance metrics.

- **Machine Learning Tools:**

- Jupyter Notebook: Interactive environment for experimentation and documentation.
- TensorBoard (if using TensorFlow): Tool for visualizing training progress and debugging models.
- Git: Version control system for managing project code and collaboration.

- **Operating System:** Compatible operating systems include Windows, Linux (Ubuntu), or macOS, depending on system requirements and library support.

Chapter 6

EXPERIMENTATION

- **Dataset Used:** The project utilized handwritten text datasets obtained from publicly available sources such as the IAM Handwriting Database and MNIST dataset. These datasets consist of images of handwritten characters, words, and sentences, collected from multiple writers. The data provides variability in writing styles, sizes, and orientations, making it suitable for training and evaluating handwriting recognition systems.
- **Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) and Preprocessing:** Through Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), insights were gained into image quality, variations in handwriting styles, and dataset distribution. This phase helped in identifying noise, skewness, and inconsistencies in the images. The preprocessing steps included grayscale conversion, noise removal, image resizing, normalization, and segmentation of text into characters or words. The dataset was then split into training and testing sets using an 80:20 ratio to ensure effective model evaluation.
- **Data Preparation and Model Selection:** The project focused on preparing image data suitable for training deep learning models. Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and OCR-based approaches were selected due to their effectiveness in image recognition tasks. The model architecture processes handwritten images and extracts meaningful features to recognize characters and words accurately.
- **Training and Hyperparameter Tuning:** The model was trained using the preprocessed dataset with careful tuning of hyperparameters such as learning rate, batch size, and number of epochs. Techniques such as data augmentation were applied to improve model generalization and handle variations in handwriting. The training process was monitored to ensure accuracy and avoid overfitting, resulting in a robust and reliable evaluation system.

Model Evaluation and Comparison: The performance of the trained model was evaluated using metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score. The system's ability to correctly recognize handwritten text was tested on unseen data from the test dataset. Comparisons were made between different approaches such as CNN-based models and OCR-based methods to identify the most efficient and accurate solution. The evaluation also considered error rates in character recognition and overall system reliability.

- **Model Interpretability:** Model interpretability was addressed by analyzing how the system processes handwritten inputs and identifies patterns. Visualization techniques such as feature maps and activation layers were used to understand how the model extracts important features from images. This helps in identifying areas where the model may misinterpret certain handwriting styles and improves transparency in decision-making.
- **Documentation and Reporting:** All stages of the project, including dataset preparation, preprocessing steps, model architecture, training process, and evaluation results, were thoroughly documented. Graphs, tables, and visualizations were used to present performance metrics clearly. The documentation ensures reproducibility of the system and provides a clear understanding of the methodology and outcomes.
- **Iterative Improvement and Future Directions:** The system was continuously improved based on evaluation results and observed limitations. Future enhancements may include improving accuracy for complex handwriting styles, integrating advanced deep learning models, and expanding the dataset for better generalization. Additional features such as real-time evaluation, multilingual support, and deployment as a web or mobile application can further enhance the system's usability and performance.

6.1 Model Selection

Our investigation focused on selecting an appropriate approach for extracting and evaluating handwritten text from images. The primary objective was to combine Optical Character Recognition (OCR) with text similarity techniques to accurately assess student answers. After careful analysis, a hybrid approach using Tesseract OCR and text similarity algorithms was chosen as the core model for this project.

Tesseract OCR + Text Similarity Evaluation:

- **Model Selection Rationale:** Tesseract OCR was selected due to its effectiveness in extracting text from handwritten and printed images. It works well when combined with image preprocessing techniques such as grayscale conversion, blurring, and thresholding using OpenCV.
- **Problem Type:** The project addresses handwritten answer recognition and automated evaluation. It involves converting handwritten answers into machine-readable text and comparing them with a model answer to assign marks.
- **Strategic Choice:** The combination of OCR and Sequence Matcher-based text similarity was chosen for its simplicity and efficiency. It allows approximate matching of words instead of exact matching, making the system tolerant to minor spelling variations in handwritten answers.
- **Analytical Framework:** The system first preprocesses the input image using OpenCV techniques such as grayscale conversion, Gaussian blur, and adaptive thresholding. Tesseract OCR is then used to extract text. The extracted student answer is compared with the model answer using a similarity ratio (Sequence Matcher), and marks are calculated based on matched words.

Comparison with Traditional Approaches:

- **Manual Evaluation:** Traditional handwritten answer checking by teachers is time-consuming, subjective, and prone to inconsistencies.
- **Deep Learning Models:** Advanced CNN-based handwriting recognition models were considered but require large datasets and high computational resources, making them less practical for this implementation.
- **Final Selection:** The OCR-based approach-combined with similarity matching was selected due to its simplicity, faster implementation, lower computational cost, and satisfactory accuracy for real-world use.

System Architecture:

- **Input Layer:** The system accepts handwritten answer images as input from both the model answer and the student answer through a user interface. These images are uploaded using interactive widgets.
- **Image Preprocessing:** The input images are processed using OpenCV techniques such as grayscale conversion, Gaussian blurring, and adaptive thresholding. This step enhances image quality and improves text extraction accuracy.
- **OCR Engine (Tesseract):** The preprocessed images are passed to the Tesseract OCR engine, which extracts text from the handwritten content and converts it into a machine-readable format.
- **Text Processing and Cleaning:** The extracted text is further processed by converting it to lowercase, removing punctuation, and splitting it into words. This ensures uniformity for accurate comparison.
- **Similarity Evaluation Module:** The processed student answer is compared with the model answer using the Sequence Matcher algorithm. It calculates similarity between words and determines how closely the student's answer matches the model answer.
- **Scoring Mechanism:** Based on the number of matched words, marks are calculated proportionally to the maximum marks. The system also computes the percentage, grade (A, B, C, Fail), and feedback.
- **Output Generation:** The final results, including marks, percentage, grade, and feedback, are displayed on the screen. Additionally, a PDF report is generated using Report Lab and automatically downloaded.
- **User Interface Layer:** The system uses interactive widgets (Ip widgets) to allow users to upload answers, enter student details, and control the evaluation process (Start, Evaluate, Next, End).

6.2 Working of the Model

- **Step 1: Input Acquisition:** The system begins by accepting handwritten answer images as input. The user uploads a model answer image and student answer image through the interface.
- **Step 2: Image Preprocessing:** The uploaded images are processed using OpenCV techniques such as grayscale conversion, Gaussian blur, and adaptive thresholding. This step enhances image clarity and reduces noise, improving OCR accuracy.
- **Step 3: Text Extraction (OCR):** The preprocessed images are passed to the Tesseract OCR engine, which extracts handwritten text and converts it into machine-readable format.
- **Step 4: Text Cleaning and Normalization:** The extracted text is converted to lowercase, punctuation is removed, and the text is split into words. This ensures consistency and improves comparison accuracy.
- **Step 5: Similarity Evaluation:** The processed student answer is compared with the model answer using the SequenceMatcher algorithm. Word-level similarity is calculated, allowing partial matches instead of exact matching.
- **Step 6: Marks Calculation:** The system calculates marks based on the ratio of matched words to total words in the model answer. The score is then converted into percentage.
- **Step 7: Grading and Feedback:** Based on the percentage, grades (A, B, C, Fail) are assigned along with feedback such as “Excellent”, “Good”, or “Needs Improvement”.
- **Step 8: Result Generation:** The evaluation results, including marks, percentage, grade, and feedback, are displayed to the user.
- **Step 9: Report Generation:** A PDF report is generated using ReportLab, containing student details and evaluation results, which is automatically downloaded.
- **Step 10: Iterative Evaluation:** The system allows evaluation of multiple student answers sequentially using options like “Next Student” and “End”.

6.2.1 How the Model Works

The proposed model works by extracting handwritten text from images using OCR and evaluating it through text similarity techniques. The following steps explain the working process:

- **Input Preparation:** The system takes handwritten answer images (model answer and student answer) uploaded by the user through the interface.
- **Image Processing:** The input images are processed using OpenCV techniques such as grayscale conversion, Gaussian blurring, and adaptive thresholding to enhance clarity and reduce noise.
- **Text Extraction:** The processed images are passed to the Tesseract OCR engine, which extracts text and converts handwritten content into machine-readable format.
- **Text Comparison:** The extracted student text is compared with the model answer text using the SequenceMatcher algorithm, which calculates similarity between words and allows partial matching.
- **Evaluation and Scoring:** Based on the similarity score, marks are calculated proportionally. The system also computes percentage, assigns grades (A, B, C, Fail), and generates feedback.
- **Output Generation:** The final evaluated result is displayed, and a PDF report is generated containing student details, marks, grade, and feedback.

6.2.2 Addressing Challenges in the Model

Although the proposed OCR-based handwritten evaluation system provides an effective solution, it faces several challenges that need to be addressed:

- **OCR Accuracy Issues:** Handwritten text varies widely in style, size, and clarity. Poor handwriting or low-quality images can reduce the accuracy of text extraction using OCR.
- **Image Quality and Noise:** Blurred images, shadows, or background noise can negatively affect preprocessing and lead to incorrect text recognition. Proper image enhancement techniques are required to handle this issue.
- **Spelling Variations and Synonyms:** Students may write correct answers using different words or sentence structures. Basic similarity matching may not fully capture semantic meaning, affecting evaluation accuracy.
- **Partial Matching Limitations:** The use of SequenceMatcher allows approximate matching but may still fail in cases where answers are conceptually correct but phrased very differently.
- **Computational Efficiency:** Processing multiple images with OCR and evaluation logic can increase computation time, especially when handling large numbers of student submissions.
- **Evaluation Fairness:** Automated systems may not fully replicate human judgment, especially for subjective or descriptive answers, leading to potential fairness concerns.
- **Scalability and Deployment:** Deploying the system for real-time use (e.g., web or mobile applications)

Chapter 7

RESULTAND ANALYSIS

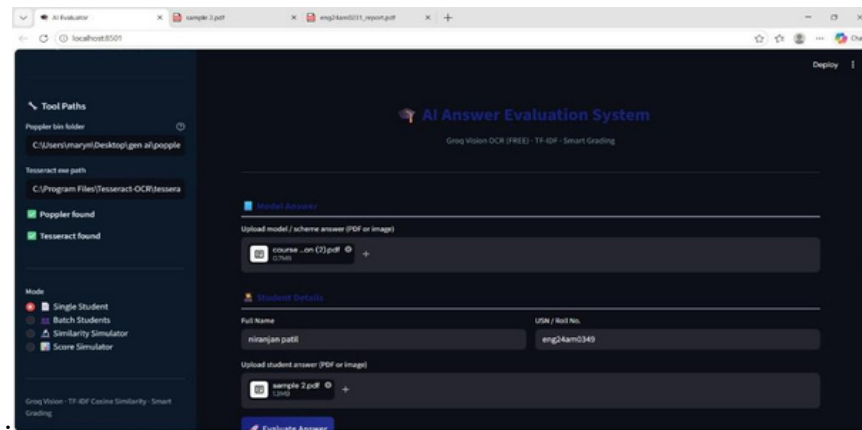


Fig 2. AI Answer Evaluation System – Main Interface

This image shows the main dashboard of an AI-based answer evaluation web application running on localhost. The system allows users to upload a model answer (PDF/image) and a student's answer, along with student details like name and USN. It includes features such as OCR processing (Groq Vision), TF- IDF similarity, and smart grading. The interface also provides options like Single Student, Batch Students, Similarity Simulator, and Score Simulator. Tool paths for dependencies like Poppler and Tesseract are configured on the left panel.

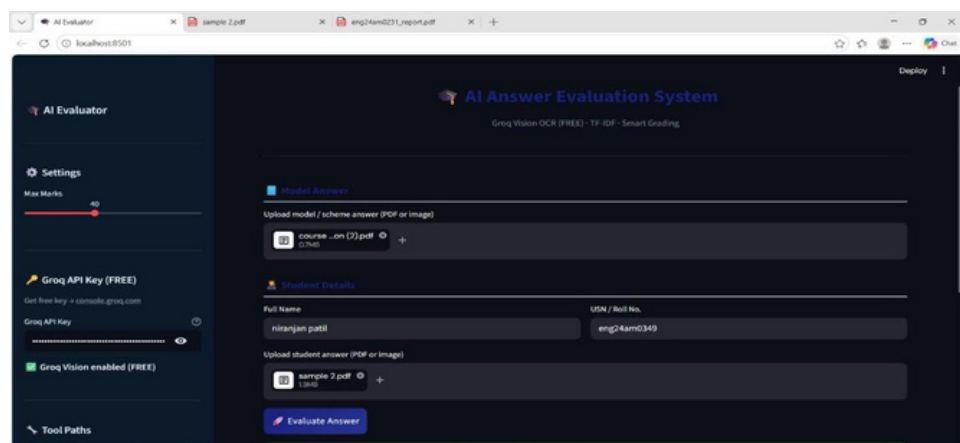


Fig 3. AI Evaluator – Settings and Evaluation Panel

This image displays the settings and evaluation section of the same AI evaluation system. It includes a marks slider(MaxMarks:40)and a field to input the Groq API key for enabling OCR functionality. The inter face confirms that GroqVision is active. Below, users can upload model and student answers and in it at evaluation using the“ Evaluate Answer” button. The layout emphasizes automated grading with configurable parameters for scoring.

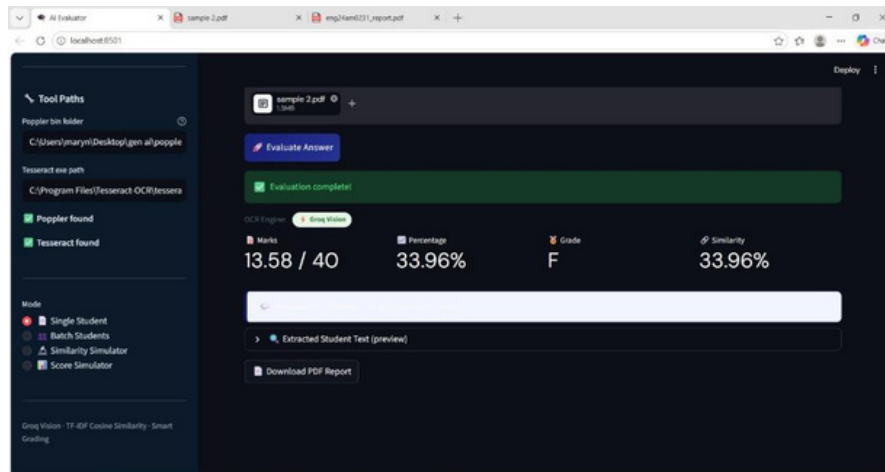


Fig 3. AI Answer Evaluation System – Result & Feedback Screen

This image shows the evaluation result page after processing a student's answer. The system indicates that evaluation is complete and displays key metrics such as Marks (13.58/40), Percentage (33.96%), Grade (F), and Similarity Score (33.96%). It also shows the OCR engine used (Groq Vision) and provides automated feedback stating that the answer needs improvement. Additional features include a preview of the extracted student text and an option to download the PDF report. This screen highlights the system's ability to perform automated grading and generate insights.

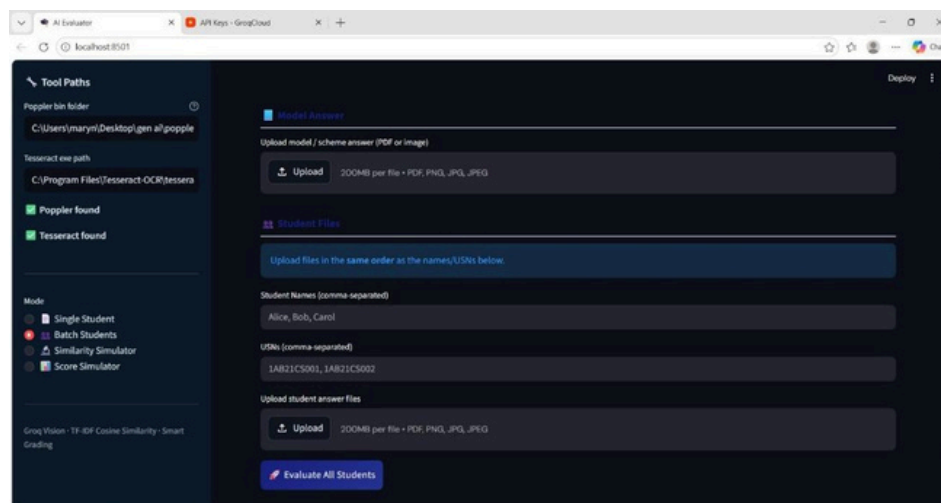


Fig 4. AI Answer Evaluation System – Batch Student Processing Interface

This image displays the batch evaluation module of the system. It allows users to upload a model answer and multiple student answer files simultaneously. Users can input student names and USNs (comma-separated) and upload corresponding answer sheets in the same order. The interface supports bulk processing with an “Evaluate All Students” button. This feature is designed for efficiently grading multiple students at once, making it suitable for classroom or institutional use.

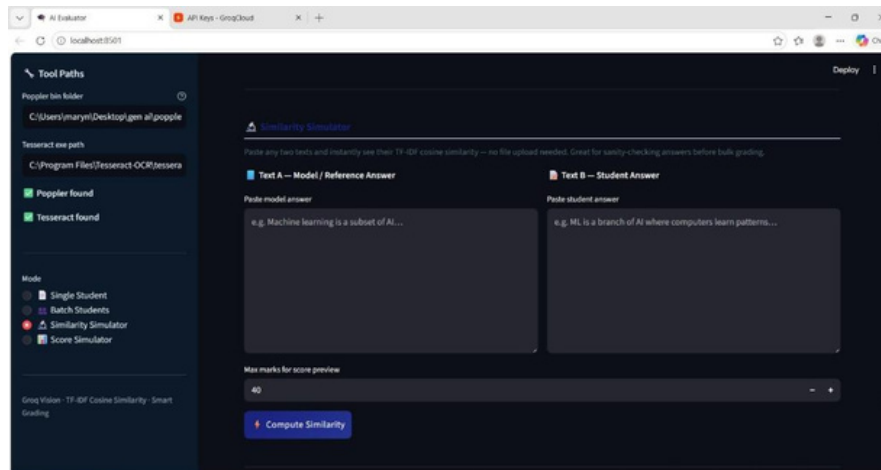


Fig 5. AI Answer Evaluation System – Similarity Simulator

This image shows the Similarity Simulator module of the AI Answer Evaluation System. It allows users to manually input two texts: Text A (Model/Reference Answer) and Text B (Student Answer). The system computes their similarity using TF-IDF cosine similarity without requiring file uploads. A maximum marks field is provided to estimate scoring based on similarity. The “Compute Similarity” button triggers the comparison. This feature is useful for quickly testing and validating answer similarity before performing full evaluation.

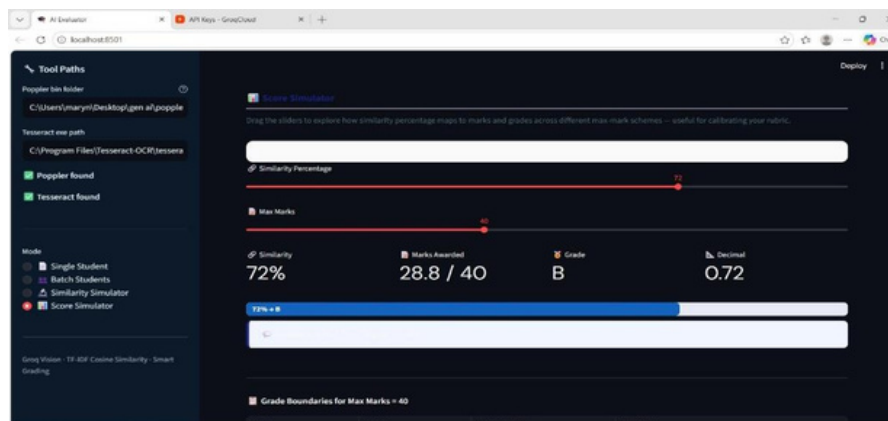


Fig 6. AI Answer Evaluation System – Score Simulator Dashboard

This image displays the Score Simulator module of the system. It allows users to adjust sliders for Similarity Percentage and Maximum Marks to observe how scores are calculated. Based on the selected similarity (72%), the system dynamically computes Marks Awarded (28.8/40), Grade (B), and Decimal Score (0.72). A visual progress bar and feedback message (“Good – minor gaps present”) are also shown. This tool helps in understanding how similarity translates into grading.

The screenshot shows the 'AI Evaluator' application window. On the left, there's a sidebar with 'Tool Paths' and 'Mode' sections. The main area displays the 'Grade Boundaries for Max Marks = 40' table.

Grade	Min %	Min Marks (/40)	Feedback
A+	≥ 90%	≥ 36.0	Outstanding – near perfect coverage.
A	≥ 80%	≥ 32.0	Excellent – strong and well-structured.
B	≥ 65%	≥ 26.0	Good – minor gaps present.
C	≥ 50%	≥ 20.0	Average – key points partially addressed.
D	≥ 35%	≥ 14.0	Below average – significant gaps.
F	≥ 0%	≥ 0.0	Insufficient – needs major improvement.

Below this table, there's another section titled 'Marks at Every 5% Similarity (Max = 40)' which is shown in Figure 8.

Fig 7. AI Answer Evaluation System – Grade Boundary Table

This image shows the grading criteria table used by the system. It defines grade ranges based on minimum percentage and marks (out of 40). For example, A+ corresponds to $\geq 90\%$ (≥ 36 marks), while lower grades follow decreasing thresholds. Each grade is associated with qualitative feedback such as “Excellent,” “Good,” or “Needs improvement.” This ensures transparency and consistency in evaluations

The screenshot shows the 'AI Evaluator' application window. On the left, there's a sidebar with 'Tool Paths' and 'Mode' sections. The main area displays the 'Marks at Every 5% Similarity (Max = 40)' table.

Similarity	Marks (/40)	Grade
0%	0	F
5%	2	F
10%	4	F
15%	6	F
20%	8	F
25%	10	F
30%	12	F
35%	14	D
40%	16	D
45%	18	D

Fig 8. AI Answer Evaluation System – Similarity vs Marks Mapping Table

This image presents a detailed mapping table showing how similarity percentage translates into marks and grades at intervals of 5%. For instance, 0–30% similarity results in low marks and grade F, while higher similarity gradually improves marks and grade levels. This table helps users clearly understand the scoring logic used in the automated evaluation system and validates how grading decisions are made.

Column Name	Type	Key	Description
answer_id	INT	PK	Unique answer ID
student_name	VARCHAR		Name of the student
usn	VARCHAR		Student USN
model_answer	TEXT		Reference answer
student_answer	TEXT		Extracted student answer (OCR)

Table 1. Student Answer Table

Column Name	Type	Key	Description
result_id	INT	PK	Unique result ID
answer_id	INT	FK	References Student_Answer
similarity_score	FLOAT		Cosine similarity score
marks	FLOAT		Marks obtained
percentage	FLOAT		Percentage score
grade	CHAR		Final grade
feedback	TEXT		Generated feedback

Table 2. Evaluation Result Table

Chapter 8

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

The AI Handwritten Evaluation System developed in this project demonstrates an efficient approach for automating the evaluation of handwritten answers. By integrating image preprocessing techniques with Tesseract OCR, the system successfully converts handwritten text into a machine-readable format. The extracted text is then evaluated using a similarity-based approach, enabling automatic calculation of marks, grades, and feedback.

The system reduces manual effort, minimizes human bias, and ensures faster evaluation compared to traditional methods. The implementation using Python, OpenCV, and OCR techniques provides a practical and cost-effective solution for academic assessment. Additionally, the ability to generate PDF reports enhances usability and makes the system suitable for real-world applications such as schools and online examinations.

Overall, the project highlights the potential of combining OCR and simple natural language processing techniques to build intelligent evaluation systems.

- **Efficient Image Processing Pipeline:** The systematic approach to image preprocessing, including grayscale conversion, noise removal, and adaptive thresholding, has proven to be effective in enhancing image quality for accurate OCR extraction. This pipeline ensures reliable recognition of handwritten text even under varying image conditions.
- **Practicality of OCR-Based Approach:** The use of Tesseract OCR provides a practical, cost-effective, and easy-to-implement solution for handwritten text recognition. It eliminates the need for complex hardware setups and enables seamless integration into real-world applications such as academic evaluation systems.

- **Dataset Selection and Diversity:** The project utilized handwritten datasets containing a variety of writing styles, formats, and character structures. This diversity helped in improving the robustness of the OCR system by exposing it to different handwriting patterns, ensuring better generalization during evaluation.
- **Holistic Approach to Evaluation:** By integrating image preprocessing techniques, OCR-based text extraction, and similarity-based evaluation, the system adopts a complete approach to automated answer checking. This not only improves efficiency but also provides consistent and unbiased evaluation, laying the foundation for smarter academic assessment systems in the future.

8.1 Implications and Future Directions:

- **Impact on Educational Systems:** The proposed system can significantly reduce the workload of teachers by automating the evaluation of handwritten answers. It ensures faster, consistent, and unbiased grading, improving overall efficiency in academic institutions.
- **Improved Assessment Accuracy:** By minimizing human errors and subjectivity, the system enhances fairness in evaluation. It provides standardized grading based on predefined criteria, ensuring uniform assessment for all students.
- **Adoption in Digital Learning Platforms:** The system can be integrated into e-learning platforms and online examination systems, enabling automated answer checking in remote learning environments.
- **Advancements with NLP Techniques:** Future improvements can include the use of Natural Language Processing (NLP) to understand the semantic meaning of answers rather than relying only on word matching, leading to more accurate evaluation.
- **Integration with Deep Learning Models:** Incorporating advanced models such as CNNs, RNNs, or Transformers can improve handwriting recognition accuracy, especially for complex and diverse writing styles.
- **Real-Time and Mobile-Based Applications:** The system can be extended to mobile or web applications, allowing real-time evaluation using camera input, making it more accessible and user-friendly.
- **Multilingual Support:** Expanding the system to support multiple languages will increase its usability across different regions and educational systems.
- **Scalability and Deployment:** With further optimization, the system can handle large-scale evaluations in schools, colleges, and competitive examinations efficiently.

8.2 Future Scope

- **Understanding Handwriting Recognition:** Explore advanced techniques in handwriting recognition, including deep learning models such as CNNs, RNNs, and Transformers to improve text extraction accuracy from complex handwritten inputs.
- **Online Courses and Learning Resources:** Enroll in courses and workshops related to Computer Vision, OCR, and Natural Language Processing (NLP) to enhance knowledge and improve system capabilities.
- **Small-Scale Enhancements:** Develop mini-projects to improve specific modules such as image preprocessing, noise reduction, and text similarity algorithms for better evaluation accuracy.
- **Research Initiatives:** Study recent research papers and case studies on OCR advancements and automated grading systems. Experiment with different datasets to improve recognition performance.
- **Semantic Evaluation Techniques:** Implement NLP-based models to understand the meaning of answers rather than relying only on keyword matching, enabling more intelligent and fair evaluation.
- **System Simulation and Testing:** Test the system under different conditions such as varying handwriting styles, image qualities, and lighting conditions to improve robustness and reliability.
- **User Interface Improvements:** Enhance the system by developing user-friendly web or mobile applications for easier access and real-time evaluation.
- **User-Centric Development:** Gather feedback from teachers and students to improve usability, accuracy, and overall system performance in real-world academic environments.
- **Knowledge Sharing:** Document the development process, challenges, and improvements. Share findings through reports, presentations, or online platforms to contribute to future research in automated evaluation systems.

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